Student Behavior & Discipline Published July 2026

Student Discipline

Discipline Committee

The Discipline Committee has jurisdiction over all cases involving student discipline and the imposition of sanctions. The committee's tasks revolve around investigating cases involving student discipline, where recommendations have to be given at the end of the investigation. It shall be composed of the following:

1. Academic Head as Ex Officio Chairman. If unavailable, the Academic Head shall assign the Program Head to the role.
2. Two (2) Faculty Representatives to be selected by the Academic Head
3. Staff Representative to be appointed by the School Administrator/Deputy School Administrator
4. A Representative from the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) or Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA), if available

If any of the above is a respondent or involved in the dispute, another official representative shall be designated.

Initial Settlement

The Academic Head, Program Head/s, and the Discipline Officer shall have joint and equal authority or control over all student disputes requiring mediation. However, the Discipline Committee shall be convened to hear complaints or disputes or both that involve the imposition of disciplinary measures.

Implementation of Disciplinary Sanctions

To help ensure an atmosphere conducive to learning, a special mechanism shall be established to administer appropriate and reasonable sanctions to erring members of the school community subject to the requirements of due process, as well as to resolve disputes among and between them.

Student Complaints

Student complaints may be filed in writing with the Discipline Committee headed by the Academic Head. When applicable, an amicable settlement between the Complainant and the Respondent may be initially pursued.

The Discipline Committee (or the Academic Head) may, on its own initiative, take notice of any breach of discipline or rule involving students even without a complaint.

Procedure for Disciplinary Cases

Due process is observed for cases that need to be investigated and may result in possible dismissal.

1. The Complainant shall submit a written complaint to the Discipline Officer. If there is no assigned Discipline Officer, it should be submitted to the Academic Head, the Ex Officio Chairman of the Discipline Committee. When applicable, an amicable settlement between the Complainant and the Respondent may be initially pursued.
2. The Discipline Officer or Academic Head shall set a meeting with the Complainant for consultation and discussion of their rights and possible consequences of pursuing the complaint.
3. If the Complainant decides to pursue the case, the written complaint shall be forwarded to the members of the Discipline Committee.
4. The Respondent shall be notified in writing of the complaint filed against them which shall contain the nature and cause of the accusation against them. The notification shall, in all cases, direct the respondent to answer the accusation within three (3) working days from receipt. Failure to do so within the prescribed period shall not delay the proceedings.
5. For student respondents who are minors, the parents or guardian shall likewise be notified in writing of the cause and accusation leveled against the Respondent.
6. The Respondent shall be advised by the Head of the Discipline Committee of their rights and of the procedure to be followed in the proceedings resolving their case.
7. Prior to the hearing, the Discipline Committee must refer the Complainant and the Respondent to the Guidance Counselor and schedule a separate one-on-one session for behavioral, emotional, and welfare purposes.
8. The Discipline Committee may schedule hearings for the reception of evidence to enable it to arrive at a proper resolution of the complaint. Hearings, reception of evidence, and other proceedings for disciplinary cases should be compelled not later than 30 working days from the receipt of the complaint. If the case involves possession of illegal drugs, dangerous weapons, or other items related to

the case, a bag search may be conducted by the Discipline Officer, or in their absence, by the School Administrator. When warranted by special circumstances, the school may also request the assistance of law enforcement personnel to ensure that inspections are conducted safely, properly, and in accordance with established protocols.

9. In the case of a hearing wherein the Respondent is summoned by the Committee, the notice of hearing shall be given to the Respondent at least five (5) working days before the scheduled hearing. The respondent shall be allowed to present evidence on their behalf.

.0. Taking into consideration all the evidence gathered during the proceedings, the Discipline Committee shall draft a resolution with a finding as to the liability of the Respondent. The resolution shall also contain a recommendation to the President/School Administrator/Deputy School Administrator as to the imposition of any penalty whenever applicable. The resolution shall be submitted to the President/School Administrator not later than 30 working days from the close of reception of evidence before the Committee.

.1. Upon receipt of the resolution of the Discipline Committee, the President/School Administrator/Deputy School Administrator shall make a decision as to whether or not to impose sanctions upon the Respondent. The decision shall be in writing and the same shall be served upon the Respondent. In the case of a Respondent being a minor, the parents or guardian of said Respondent shall also be served with the same. A copy of the resolution addressed to the Complainant should also be provided.

.2. An appeal to the President/School Administrator/Deputy School Administrator's decision may be made within 10 working days from receipt of the said decision by an appealing party. The appeal may come from either the Respondent or the Complainant and shall be addressed to the Office of the President/School Administrator.

.3. The School Administration reserves the right to place a Respondent under suspension pending appeal.

.4. The decision of the Discipline Committee shall be final and executory if not appealed within the given period.

.5. The Discipline Committee shall give a copy of the final resolution along with a Referral Form to the Guidance Office prior to the imposition of any disciplinary action or sanction.

.6. The Discipline Committee shall call for a conference with the Respondent and their parents or guardian and a separate conference with the Complainant and their parents or guardian to discuss the final resolution. Both parties shall be provided with their own copy of the final resolution.

The Procedure of the Guidance and Counseling Office in Handling Discipline Cases Referred by the Discipline Committee

1. The Guidance Counselor/Associate shall receive a Referral Form from the Discipline Committee with a copy of the Incident Report.
2. The Guidance Counselor/Associate will conduct check-in and aftercare sessions with the student/s concerned throughout the case proceedings.
3. The Guidance Counselor/Associate will provide the Discipline Committee with relevant feedback of the check-in and aftercare session with the student/s.

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This handbook is subject to regular review. The version issued by STI is authoritative.